

ClipGrow

Agency Operating System

How the agency runs on Discord — the roles people hold, how they are recruited and trained, how campaigns are staffed and run, and how the money works.

Who this is for

The ClipGrow team — Dhruv, Spandan, Endrig, and anyone brought in to help run operations. Read it end to end, then bring your questions: the last section lists the decisions still open.

Confidential

This document contains internal pricing and margin figures (\$10). Those are **not** for clipper-facing materials. Share the document only with the core team.

1. What this is and why

ClipGrow runs clipping campaigns for brands. Clippers cut short videos from a brand's source material, post them to their own social accounts, and get paid per 1,000 views. Recruitment and vetting were run out of one WhatsApp group and it stopped scaling.

This system replaces that with a Discord-based pipeline where people sort and train *themselves* up a clear ladder, campaigns are run by delegated managers, and the ClipGrow website stays the single source of truth for money and account credentials.

Two problems it is built to solve

- **Too many unqualified applicants to sort by hand.** Most people who show up cannot edit a video yet. They need to sort and train themselves with almost no staff time.
- **“Editor” is not “Clipper.”** An editor can cut a clean video. A **clipper** understands virality — hooks, watch-through, consumer psychology, account curation, what works in a niche. Closing that gap is the whole point of the ladder.

A third goal runs through everything: **control**. ClipGrow holds the money and the credentials. Nobody gets a login, campaign access, or a role until they have earned the stage they are at — and taking it back is one action.

The three systems

System	Who is in it	What it does
Discord	internal only — every rank, every staff member	recruitment, training, campaign coordination, roles and access control
ClipGrow website	clippers, clients, admins	system of record: campaigns, participations, view tracking, earnings, payouts, credentials
WhatsApp	existing members, during migration only	being retired — see §12

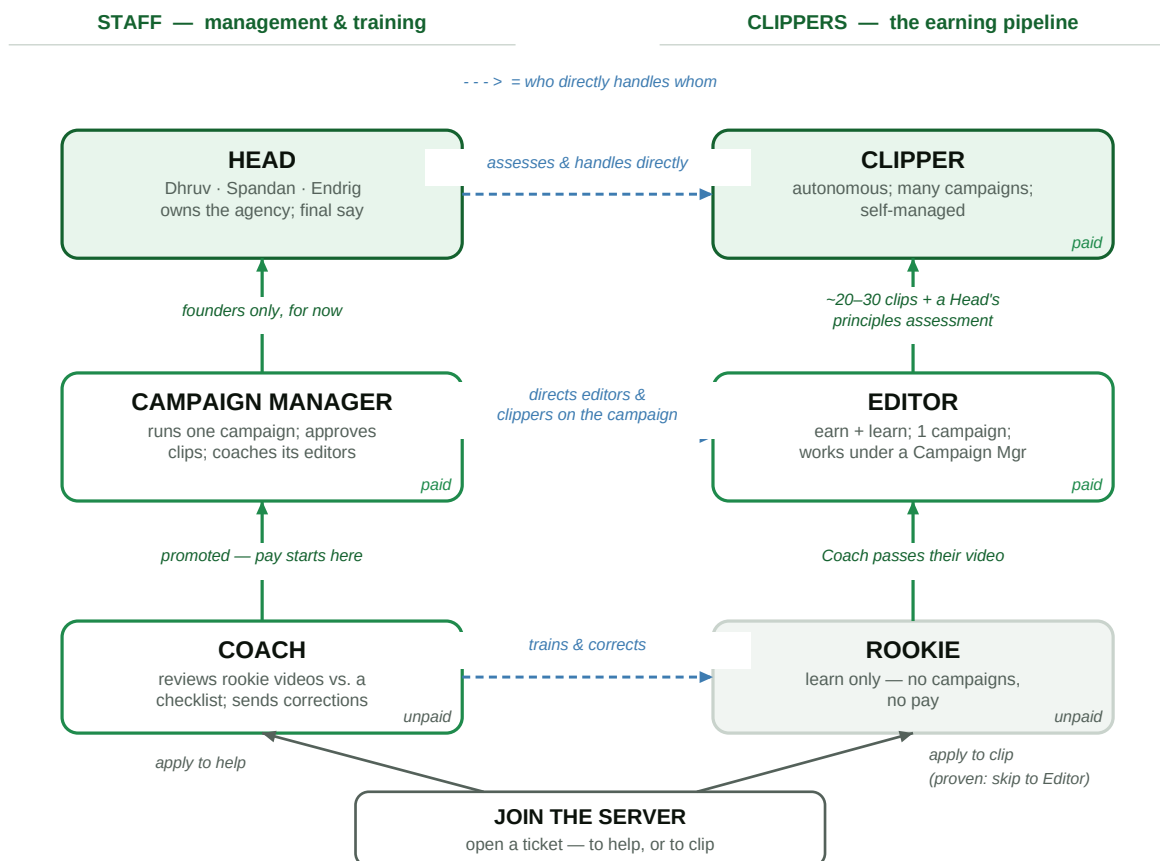
Rule of thumb: if it is about money, tracking, or credentials it lives in ClipGrow. If it is about people, training, or campaign coordination it lives in Discord. The two stay in sync automatically (§13). **Clients never enter Discord** — Spandan handles them directly and they watch progress on the website.

2. The hierarchy — two interlinked ladders

There are **two ladders**, and they run side by side.

- The **clipper ladder** (right): **Rookie to Editor to Clipper**. These are the people doing the clipping work and earning from it.
- The **staff ladder** (left): **Coach to Campaign Manager to Head**. These are the people who run the agency and handle everyone on the clipper ladder.

Both ladders are entered the same way — anyone in the server opens a ticket: one to **help** (start as a Coach), one to **clip** (start as a Rookie, or fast-lane straight to Editor if they can already prove it).



Who directly handles whom

- The **Coach** handles **Rookies** — reviews their practice videos and sends corrections.
- The **Campaign Manager** handles the **Editors and Clippers on their campaign** — sets the rules, approves or rejects clips, answers questions.
- The **Head** handles the **Campaign Managers** (oversight, escalation) and handles **Clippers directly** — Clippers are autonomous freelancers, so their rank, their assessment, and anything above a Campaign Manager's pay grade goes straight to a Head.

The staff pipeline — and how pay works on it

- **Coach is the entry-level staff role, open to anyone in the server** (you do not have to be a clipper). It is **unpaid** — it is a way to prove you are reliable and can give good feedback.

- **A Coach who does the work well is promoted to Campaign Manager — and that is where pay begins.** Campaign Managers are paid based on their contribution to the campaigns they run (structure to be set — §17).
- **Head** is the founders (Dhruv, Spandan, Endrig) for now. Client Lead (Spandan, client acquisition, outside Discord) and Tech (Endrig, Discord + the bot) are Head-level function hats, not separate rungs.

3. The clipper ladder in detail

Multiple entry points. You can skip rungs by proving you are ready.

Rank	Mode	Gets	Campaigns at once	How you move up
Rookie	Learn only	editing software, training library, practice footage, a personal iteration ticket	none — no real campaigns, no earnings	a Coach passes their practice video against the checklist
Editor	Earn and learn	a ClipGrow login, real campaign work under a Campaign Manager	exactly 1 (hard cap)	post ~20–30 clips, feel ready, then a Head runs the principles conversation
Clipper	Earn — capped only by skill	full autonomy, tool presets, business knowledge, near-zero oversight	several	— (top of the ladder)

Entry point

- No real editing experience -> you start as a **Rookie**.
- Genuine experience, verified -> you start as an **Editor** (the “fast lane”).
- **The fast lane caps at Editor.** However strong a portfolio is, nobody is made a Clipper at intake. “Clipper” always means someone a Head has personally assessed.

Skipping rungs: at any point you can ask to move up early by submitting proof (a video, plus — for Clipper — demonstrated understanding). The reviewer is the same person who would normally promote you into that rung; the proof just triggers it early.

4. Getting in — intake and routing

- **Step 1.** Person joins the Discord server and accepts the rules (Membership Screening).
- **Step 2.** They can now see the entry channels only: **#rules**, **#how-it-works**, **#apply**.
- **Step 3. Everyone fills one short application** (a form): how many videos have you edited (zero is fine), your social accounts, portfolio link, 2–3 sample clips.

Auto-routing

- Application shows **no real proof** -> automatically assigned **Rookie**, a personal iteration ticket opens, they are pointed at the Training area. **No staff time spent.**
- Application **claims real experience** -> flagged to a Coach / a Head for a quick “fast-lane” check. Holds up -> **Editor**. Does not -> **Rookie**.

At ~20–100 applicants a week, only the experience-claim minority ever needs a human glance — the cousin can absorb that.

5. Rookie — the self-serve training track

Goal: turn someone who can (or cannot yet) edit into an Editor who reliably delivers clean, on-spec videos.

What a Rookie gets

- **Editing software.** (Decision to lock — \$16. Recommendation: free/legit tools such as CapCut and DaVinci Resolve.)
- **A training library** — videos, guides, examples — sequenced into a path. (This content is currently scattered and needs assembling — \$16.)
- **Practice source material** to edit and experiment with.
- **One iteration ticket** — their personal thread. Submit a video; a Coach leaves specific corrections *in the same ticket*; revise and re-submit; repeat. The whole back-and-forth stays in one place so progress is visible.

Who reviews: a **Coach** — deliberately low-skill, high-volume work driven by a fixed checklist. Delegable; anyone can be slotted in without retraining.

Promotion: when a Rookie's video clears the checklist, the Coach promotes them. The system then **creates their ClipGrow login and DMs it to them**, assigns Editor, removes Rookie, closes the ticket. **This is the moment credentials are issued — never before.**

6. Editor — earn and learn

- Works **one** real campaign at a time (hard cap — keeps them focused while learning), posts to their own account, earns per views like anyone.
- Works **under a Campaign Manager**. The Manager sets the rules — style, do/don't, which source material — and the Editor picks the moments to cut and makes the creative calls inside those rails. The Manager approves or rejects each clip before it counts toward pay. (Exact direction level — \$16.)
- **Gets onto a campaign** by browsing the campaign board, applying to one, and submitting a verification video cut from that campaign's material; the Campaign Manager approves it.

7. Clipper — the autonomous freelancer

A Clipper knows the whole craft and the whole business: hooks, retention, consumer psychology, niche fit, account curation (aesthetic feed, naming, colour, theme, cadence), which tools and presets to use, how CPM and view quality work, what gets a clip disqualified and why.

- **A freelancer, not a managed worker.** We do not tell them what to do. They pick which campaigns to work; we offer incentives to attract them to the ones we need filled.
- Near-zero oversight. Several campaigns at once.
- Still films a verification video for every campaign they join (every campaign's style differs) — but they are added to the campaign channels instantly on request, and the video is a fast trust-based check, not a gate.

8. Editor -> Clipper

- The system tracks an Editor's cumulative posted-clip count. At **~20–30 clips** it flags them in a staff channel as eligible.
- When the Editor feels they have the quality and understand the business, they open a **Level-up ticket**.

- A **Head** (Dhruv or Spandan — nobody else) runs the **principles conversation**: questions on hooks, retention, psychology, niche, account curation, the business, and judgement — *what to do, when, and why* — going back and forth against a shared rubric.
- Ready -> promoted. The system swaps Editor for Clipper and unlocks multi-campaign access and brief browsing.
- Not ready -> the Head writes the specific gaps into the ticket; the Editor keeps working and re-opens it later.

9. Campaigns

The Campaign Manager

The middle rung of the staff ladder, and the **first paid** staff role. One person per campaign, assigned when the campaign is created. Today the three Heads fill these; the intent is that **Coaches who prove themselves are promoted into this role**, and their pay is tied to the campaigns they run (comp structure to be set — §17).

- **Powers:** approve/reject submitted clips before they count toward pay; moderate the campaign channels; a scoped view of the ClipGrow admin portal for their campaign.
- **Owns:** the campaign end to end; making sure every clip complies with the brand guidelines; every Editor and Clipper on it reports to them; first answer-desk for its questions; reviewing verification videos; coaching its Editors toward Clipper (the deep principles assessment still goes to a Head).
- **Must know:** every brand guideline cold; exactly what video type and style the campaign needs and what “good” looks like in its niche; the quality-check bar; how to give fast, specific, actionable feedback; the ClipGrow campaign controls.

Lifecycle

Step	What happens
Create	Spandan closes a deal outside Discord and enters the campaign on the ClipGrow website (name, CPM, budget, min views, max payout, platforms, brief, source assets). A Head then imports it into Discord — the system creates its category and channels (#brief, #submissions, #chat), its role, and a board post — and assigns a Campaign Manager, who fills #brief with the detailed style guide.
Staff — Editor	Editor applies from the board -> private ticket with the brief -> submits handle + verification video -> Manager reviews -> approves -> the system creates the participation in ClipGrow, raises the account-access request, and assigns the campaign role.
Staff — Clipper	Clipper clicks Join -> gives their handle -> instantly gets the campaign role, participation, and access request. Posts a verification clip in the campaign chat; the Manager glances at it and approves the access so they can go live.
Run	Clippers connect their account on the ClipGrow dashboard, post, and their links flow into ClipGrow. The Manager approves/rejects each clip; approved clips accrue earnings against the campaign budget.
Control	Pause / resume / remove a person on a campaign, or revoke them from the agency — each action sets Discord and ClipGrow at once, so they cannot drift.
Close	The campaign is marked completed in ClipGrow (which frees the connected accounts for reuse), the campaign role is removed from everyone, the channels are archived, and a wrap-up is posted.

10. How the money works

There are two revenue streams: the **CPM campaign** (the core business) and **video licensing** / bounties (a client paying to post a clip on their own official account).

10.1 The CPM base

- Clippers are paid **per 1,000 views** on the clips they post to their own accounts. The CPM rate is set per campaign (currently around Rs 30–Rs 50 per 1,000 views).
- Each campaign has a **budget** (a cap on total payout) and a **max payout per video** (a per-clip ceiling). Both vary campaign to campaign.
- **A paid clip is closed out for good.** Views it gains after payout earn nothing. (This is a deliberate model choice — not a period-based one where a viral clip keeps paying for months.)
- Payouts run monthly via UPI, above a minimum withdrawal threshold.

10.2 Why CPM is the right deal for the clipper

- **Zero investment, zero risk.** No upfront cost, no follower requirement, no equipment beyond a phone. Anyone can try.
- **Paid for exactly what they produce.** A clip that performs earns more; a clip that flops costs them nothing but time. There is no salary ceiling on a good week.
- **They build their own asset.** Every clip is posted from the clipper's own account, which keeps growing views and followers that are theirs to keep.
- **Predictable and transparent.** The rate, the min-views threshold, and the per-video cap are all in the brief before they commit. Earnings update on their dashboard as views come in.
- **Upside within the budget.** A strong clipper working several campaigns can stack earnings; the only limit per clip is the campaign's max payout.

10.3 ClipGrow's 20% management fee

ClipGrow's core revenue is a **20% management fee**. The brand funds the campaign; ClipGrow runs sourcing, distribution, view verification, quality control and payouts, and takes 20% for it. This is already stated publicly on the site ("20% Management Fee") and shown to clippers as the campaign's commission rate.

10.4 Bounties / pay-per-video (video licensing)

When a client likes a specific video and wants to post it on their **own official account**, they license it from us — a one-off "pay-per-video." It is priced off that campaign's **max payout per video** (which differs campaign to campaign).

	Amount	As % of max payout
Client pays ClipGrow ("main-account portion")	50% of max payout	50%
ClipGrow keeps (20% of that)	20% × 50%	10%
Clipper receives (80% of that)	80% × 50%	40%

Worked example — a campaign with a Rs 10,000 max payout per video:

- Client licenses a clip -> pays ClipGrow **Rs 5,000** (50% of max payout).

- ClipGrow keeps **Rs 1,000** (20% of Rs 5,000).
- Clipper is paid **Rs 4,000** (80% of Rs 5,000 = 40% of max payout).

Internal — not for clipper-facing materials

Clippers are told **only their own number** — an amount equal to 40% of the campaign's max payout per video. They are **not** shown the "50% of max payout" client price or the 80/20 split. In every campaign's clipper-facing terms, state it as a flat figure, e.g. "Rs 4,000 to license this video."

10.5 Campaign terms — the licensing clause (clipper-facing)

From now on, every campaign's terms must include a clause to this effect:

Standard clipper-facing clause

"If the client chooses to license one of your videos to post on their own official account, ClipGrow will pay you an amount equal to **40% of this campaign's maximum per-video payout** in exchange for that video and the client's right to post it."

- The exact rupee figure is written into each brief (40% of that campaign's max payout).
- **Open question for the team:** does the licensing payment stack *on top of* the view-based earnings the clip has already accrued, or replace them? Decide before the first bounty is offered — §16.

11. Clients

- Clients **never** join Discord.
- Spandan owns the entire client relationship outside it — DMs, calls, docs.
- Clients have a **ClipGrow website login** to watch their campaign's progress and results. They see budget and spend; they never see what an individual clipper is paid.
- Campaigns originate on the ClipGrow website; Discord imports them.

12. WhatsApp migration

(Decision to lock — §16. Recommended:) new people go straight to Discord now. Existing WhatsApp members are invited over the next 2–4 weeks; known-good people are fast-tracked straight to Editor (or higher after a Head's assessment). After the window, the WhatsApp group closes. One system.

13. What stays in sync automatically

Discord	ClipGrow
Editor role	a clipper account exists, tier = editor
Clipper role	tier = clipper
a Discord user <-> their ClipGrow account	a stored link
campaign role	an active participation in that campaign
paused on a campaign	that participation paused, earnings frozen
removed from a campaign	that participation kicked, earnings frozen
Removed role	ClipGrow account disabled (history kept)
campaign channels archived	campaign marked completed

Once a night the system compares the two and reports any drift into a staff channel for a human to fix. **Money — CPM, earnings, payouts — stays entirely inside ClipGrow.**

14. The team — who wears what

Person	Roles / hats	Owns
Dhruv	Head, Campaign Manager	oversight, final escalation, Clipper assessment, campaigns
Spandan ("Sandy")	Head, Client Lead, Campaign Manager	all client acquisition and relationships (outside Discord); Clipper assessment; campaigns
Endrig	Head, Tech, Campaign Manager	Discord configuration and the bot; the ClipGrow integration; campaigns
Cousin	Coach	Rookie to Editor review (checklist-driven); general manual ops

Beyond this: **Coach** is open to anyone in the server via a ticket (unpaid); a Coach who does well is promoted to **Campaign Manager** (paid). That is the path to growing the team without hiring.

15. Channels (the Discord map)

ENTRY everyone past screening #rules #how-it-works #apply COMMUNITY Rookie + Editor + Clipper #announcements #general #wins TRAINING Rookie (full) · Editor (read) #training-library #software-and-tools #practice-brief #your-progress CAMPAIGN BOARD Editor + Clipper #open-campaigns one post per live campaign, Apply/Join button #campaign-help CAMPAIGN - campaign role + Campaign Manager + Head #<name>-brief (Clippers can also read this to choose campaigns) #<name>-submissions #<name>-chat STAFF staff only #coach-queue fast-lane checks + Rookie escalations #campaign-review verification-video review #level-ups Editor->Clipper tickets + auto-flags at ~25 clips #bot-log every automated action + nightly drift report #creds-audit who got a login, when (Heads only) #staff-chat

Paused and **Removed** are restriction overlays applied on top of someone's normal roles.

16. Knowledge bar per rank

What a person must be able to do to hold each rank. Use this when recruiting, coaching, and assessing.

Coach (the entry staff role)

- Does **not** need to be a clipper. Needs to be reliable, responsive, and able to write clear, specific feedback.
- Knows the Rookie checklist cold and applies it the same way every time.
- Escalates anything the checklist does not cover to a Campaign Manager or Head.

Rookie to Editor (the Coach checks)

- Operate the editing software: cuts, trims, captions, music sync, correct aspect ratio and export settings.
- Follow a spec: right length, right format, safe margins, caption style.
- Take a correction and re-deliver without hand-holding.
- Hit a basic quality bar: clean cuts, readable captions, synced audio, no watermarks.

Editor (to work campaigns)

- All of the above, reliably and at speed.
- Read a brand brief and stay inside its guidelines.
- Pick usable moments from source material.
- Meet deadlines; communicate in the campaign channel.

Editor -> Clipper (a Head assesses)

- **Hooks:** what makes someone stop scrolling in the first 1–2 seconds.
- **Retention:** structuring a 20–45s clip so people watch to the end.
- **Consumer psychology:** why a viewer shares, follows, or comments.
- **Niche fit:** what performs in this brand's niche versus another.
- **Account curation:** aesthetic feed, naming, colour grade, consistent theme, posting cadence.
- **The business:** how CPM works, why view quality matters, what gets a clip disqualified, why the brand cares.
- **Judgement:** what to make, when, and why — able to explain the reasoning, not just follow a template.

Campaign Manager

- Every brand guideline for the campaign, cold — every do and don't.
- Exactly what video type and style the campaign needs, and what “good” looks like for its niche.

- The quality-check bar and how to apply it consistently.
- How to give fast, specific, actionable feedback.
- How to coach an Editor toward Clipper.
- The ClipGrow admin portal for the campaign: approving/rejecting clips, reading view data, flagging, the payout view.
- When to escalate to a Head.

17. Decisions still to lock — bring your questions here

#	Decision	Current lean
1	Rookie editing software	free/legit tools (recommended) vs. continuing to provide cracked tools (legal exposure for the registered company noted)
2	Training curriculum ownership	scattered notes + videos today; someone must collect and sequence them before the Rookie track can go live
3	Editor direction level	Manager sets rules and the Editor picks the clips (recommended) vs. Manager hands out specific assignments
4	Coach onboarding	anyone can open a ticket to be a Coach (unpaid). What is the bar to accept someone, and who screens the applications?
5	WhatsApp	timed sunset (recommended) vs. keep as top-of-funnel vs. broadcast-only
6	Bounty payment stacking	does a video-licensing payment stack on top of the CPM the clip already earned, or replace it? decide before the first bounty
7	Coach to Campaign Manager promotion	what does a Coach have to do / for how long before they are promoted, and who decides?
8	Campaign Manager pay	this is the first paid staff role. Flat per-campaign fee, % of campaign spend, performance bonus, or a mix? Set before promoting the first Coach.
9	Bot hosting	covered in the separate bot build spec — Endrig's call

Companion document: **ClipGrow Discord Bot — Build Spec** (for Endrig) covers how the bot is built, how it talks to the ClipGrow website, the API ClipGrow needs to expose, Cloudflare/credentials setup, and how to work on it together.